



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

ācāraḥ paramo dharmaḥ śruti.uktaḥ smārta eva ca | 1.108a
tasmād asmin sadā yukto nityaṃ syād ātmavān dvijaḥ || 108 || 1.108c

— Manusmṛti, 1.10. Excursus: Treatise of Manu (Chapter 10), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Right conduct, the verse tells us, is the highest dharma, the supreme principle of righteousness. This conduct is described as twofold, originating from both the revealed scriptures (śruti), like the Vedas, and the remembered traditions (smṛti), such as the Manusmṛti itself. The verse emphasizes that a twice-born individual (dvija), someone who has undergone spiritual initiation, should always be diligently engaged in this right conduct, remaining ever mindful and self-controlled (ātmavān).

The essence here isn't merely following rules blindly, but understanding that righteous behavior, in its broadest sense, is the path to spiritual growth. Śruti provides the foundational principles, the cosmic laws that govern existence. Smṛti, on the other hand, offers practical guidance, contextualizing those principles for specific times, places, and social structures. Both are vital, as a building requires both a strong foundation and a well-defined structure to be habitable.

In modern life, this translates to living with intention and integrity. It means acting in accordance with your values, which are ideally rooted in timeless wisdom and adapted to the realities of the present. It requires self-awareness, constantly reflecting on your actions and their impact on yourself and others. The "twice-born" aspect can be understood as a continual process of self-renewal, shedding old habits and embracing higher ideals. It's about striving to be better today than you were yesterday, not through rigid adherence to dogma, but through conscious and compassionate action. It means considering the ethical implications of your choices, from your consumption habits to your relationships, and aligning them with a deeper sense of purpose. It's a call to cultivate inner strength and use it to navigate the complexities of the world with grace and wisdom. By embracing righteous conduct as your guiding principle, you cultivate inner peace and contribute to a more harmonious world.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

In what specific areas of your life could you more consciously align your actions with your deepest values, and what small step can you take today to begin that process?